

MScAC Initiative Budget Proposal

Event: Lunar New Year Celebration & Alumni Mixer

Date: Thursday, February 12, 2026, 6:00 PM to 9:00 PM

Venue: MScAC Office 9014 (Main Collaborative Space)

Estimated Attendance: 35–40 (20–25 current students + 15 alumni/seniors)

Purpose

To celebrate the cultural heritage of the significant East and Southeast Asian diaspora within the MScAC cohort and foster community across year groups. Following the high interest shown in preliminary Discord polling, this event serves as both a cultural milestone and a networking opportunity. By inviting alumni back to the office for traditional festivities like the Lo Hei (Prosperity Toss), we aim to strengthen the bond between current students and the professional alumni network in a relaxed, festive environment.

Event Components

- **Catering & Lo Hei:** A full Chinese dinner featuring auspicious dishes (dumplings, noodles, and fish). The centerpiece will be the Lo Hei (Singaporean/Malaysian prosperity toss), a collaborative activity where participants toss ingredients together to welcome good fortune for the coming year.
- **Festive Snacks:** Sourced from ShopMalaysia Canada.
- **Dessert from The Sweet Spot:** Bing Fen and other traditional Asian desserts for all attendees to conclude the meal on a sweet, festive note.
- **Karaoke Station:** A dedicated area in MScAC 9014 for students and alumni to engage in one of the most popular social pastimes within the diaspora.
- **Themed Door Gifts:** "Hongbao" (red envelopes) containing small themed items or vouchers, and Year of the Horse-themed memorabilia to commemorate the 2026 Lunar New Year.

RSVP Plan

- **Current Students:** Final headcounts and dietary restrictions are being finalized via the MScAC Discord (19 positive responses already logged).
- **Alumni & Seniors:** Outreach will be conducted via the MScAC official mailing lists, to coordinate with the program staff
- **Deadlines:** RSVPs will close on the Monday (Feb 9) prior to the event to finalize catering quantities and gift counts.

Other Next Steps

- Coordinate with office management regarding after-hours access for alumni.
- Design and distribute digital invitations for the MScAC mailing list.
- Submit receipts, invitation, and attendee list for reimbursement.

Total Budget Requested: \$2,315

(see breakdown below)

Item	Description	Estimated Cost
Catering	Full Chinese dinner (trays of mains/sides) for ~45 people	\$1000
Dessert	Bing Fen and Asian desserts from The Sweet Spot	\$650
Lo Hei Platters	Lou Hee Yee Sang Package (5)	\$250
Festive Snacks	Yong Sheng Prune Layer Cake, Pineapple Tart, Prawn Roll, Bangkit, Fish Crackers	\$275
Gifts & Decor	Red envelopes, themed decor, and small door gifts	\$150
Total		\$2,315